

LESSON 9

Commands and Intentions

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–8

Before diving into new material, take a moment to consolidate what you have learned so far. Lessons 1–8 have introduced you to the following foundational topics:

- **Lesson 0:** The Estrangela alphabet
- **Lesson 1:** Noun states, independent pronouns, verbless clauses, and the particles *d-* and *l-*
- **Lesson 2:** The Peal active participle with enclitic pronouns (the narrative present)
- **Lesson 3:** The Peal perfect (*qṭal*) — all persons and numbers; V-S-O word order
- **Lesson 4:** Pronominal suffixes on nouns and prepositions; *ʿit l-* (“to have”)
- **Lesson 5:** The Aphel stem — causation
- **Lesson 6:** The Paael stem — intensive and factitive meaning
- **Lesson 7:** Weak roots: I-Alaph, I-Yodh, and III-Yodh verbs
- **Lesson 8:** The Peal imperfect (*neqṭol*): the future, and *d-* + imperfect for purpose

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer each question from memory before checking against your notes. Write your answer in full Syriac script with transliteration.

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	What is the Peal perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>k-t-b</i> (write)?	<i>ktab</i> — he wrote	ܠܝܬܒ
2	What is the Peal imperfect 3 m.sg. of <i>š-m-ʿ</i> (hear)?	<i>nešmaʿ</i> — he will hear	ܬܫܡܥ
3	How do you say “the king commanded” (<i>p-q-d</i> , 3 m.sg. perfect)?	<i>pqad malkā</i> — the king commanded	ܩܕܡܠܟܐ
4	What does the Paael stem add to the root’s meaning?	Intensity, repetition, or a denominative meaning	—
5	Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of <i>n-p-q</i> (go out).	<i>ʿappeq</i> — he brought out / caused to go out	ܥܦܩ

SECTION 2: THE IMPERATIVE

2.1 What Is the Imperative?

The imperative is the grammatical form used to issue **direct commands** or requests addressed to a second person (“you”). In Syriac, as in Hebrew and Arabic, the imperative exists only in the second person — singular and plural, masculine and feminine. There is no first-person or third-person imperative; those ideas are expressed by other means (the cohortative and the jussive).

The **formation** of the Peal imperative follows a straightforward rule: take the **imperfect form**, strip away the **t-** prefix of the 2nd person, and you have the imperative. The vowel pattern is then **CCoC** for the masculine singular (e.g., *ktob* “write!”). This parallels the Hebrew Qal imperative (כתוב *ktōv*) and the Arabic imperative (اكتب *uktub*), though the exact vowel patterns differ.

2.2 Peal Imperative — Formation

Masculine Singular: **CCoC** — the simplest form, the bare root with the characteristic o-vowel. E.g., **ktob** ܠܝܬܒ “Write! (to one man)”

Feminine Singular: **CCoC + -ī** — add the feminine marker *ī*. E.g., **ktobī** ܠܝܬܒܝ “Write! (to one woman)”

Masculine Plural: *CCoC + -w* — add the masculine plural ending. E.g., **ktobw** כתוב “Write! (to a group of men)”

Feminine Plural: *CCoC + -ān* — add the feminine plural ending. E.g., **ktobān** כתוב “Write! (to a group of women)”

2.3 Complete Paradigm Tables

Root k-t-b כתב (write)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg (m. sg.)	כתוב ktob	Write! (to one man)	e man)
2fsg (f. sg.)	כתובי ktobī	Write! (to one woman)	e woman)
2mpl (m. pl.)	כתובו ktobw	Write! (to a group of men)	group of men)
2fpl (f. pl.)	כתובנה ktobān	Write! (to a group of women)	group of women)

Root š-m-‘ שמע (hear)

PERSON/GENDER/NUMBER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	LITERAL MEANING
2msg	שמע šma ‘	Hear! (to one man)	man)
2fsg	שמעי šma ‘ ī	Hear! (to one woman)	woman)
2mpl	שמעו šma ‘ w	Hear! (to a group of men)	roup of men)
2fpl	שמענה šma ‘ ān	Hear! (to a group of women)	roup of women)

2.4 Derived Stems: Pael and Aphel Imperatives

Pael Imperative: The Pael intensifies or extends the root meaning. Its imperative is built from the Pael imperfect. The form is **mCaCC-e** (msg) — note the characteristic doubled middle radical. E.g., **bārek** בָּרַךְ “Bless! / Praise!”; **‘allep** אָלַץ “Teach!”

Aphel Imperative: The Aphel is causative. Its imperative begins with **’a-**. E.g., **’appaq** אֶפְקֹ “Bring out!”; **’ahwī** אֶהַרְוֵ “Show!”

2.5 Negative Commands

Key Rule: Negating Commands

In Syriac, negative commands (prohibitions) are NOT formed with the imperative.

Instead, use: lā + IMPERFECT (2nd person).

This is identical to Biblical Hebrew (לֹא + jussive / יָצַו + imperfect) and Arabic (لا + mudāri‘).

Example: lā tektob ܠܐ ܬܬܝܒ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not write!” (lit. “you-shall-not write”)

Example: lā tešma‘ ܠܐ ܬܫܡܥ ܐܝܬܝܢ = “Do not listen!”

2.6 Cross-Linguistic Comparison

Students coming from different language backgrounds will find useful parallels:

LANGUAGE	FORM (WRITE!)	FORM (HEAR!)	NEGATIVE	NOTES
Syriac	ktob ܬܬܝܒ	šma‘ ܬܫܡܥ	lā + imperfect	2nd person only; 4 forms (g/n)
Hebrew	ktōv כָּתוּב	šma‘ שְׁמַע	לֹא + jussive	Similar 4-form paradigm
Arabic	uktub اكتب	isma‘ اسمع	لا + imperfect	Form I imperative derived from imperfect
Greek	γράφε / γράψον	ἄκουε / ἄκουσον	μή + subjunctive	Pres./Aor. distinction; no gender
Latin	scribe	audi	noli + infinitive	4th conjugation; no gender marking

2.7 Example Commands with Interlinear Gloss

Study each command carefully. The word-by-word gloss is given directly below the Syriac.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܕܠܝܬܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ * ܕܠܝܬܐ	ktob šmeh d-malkā* w of-the.king	rite! name-his W the king!	rite the name of
ܫܡܐ * ܩܠܝܬܐ	šma' qālī* h	ear! voice-my H	ear my voice!
ܐܝܢܐ * ܕܥܝܢܐ	haww yāq' īn* b	e-pl. knowing K [m.pl.]	now (be knowing)!
ܠܐ ܬܕܗܠ * ܢ	lā tedḥal* n	ot you-fear D	o not be afraid!
ܐܠܝܐ * ܕܥܠܝܐ	'ezlaw w-emraw* g say-pl.!	o-pl.! and G [m.pl.]	o and tell!
ܐܬܬܐ * ܕܥܬܐ	'aḥwāynī 'attā* s	how-me! sign S	how me a sign!

SECTION 3: THE INFINITIVE (VERBAL NOUN / MAŠDAR)

3.1 The Nature of the Syriac Infinitive

Syriac, like Arabic and Hebrew, possesses a **verbal noun** — a noun derived from the verb root that expresses the action in abstract form. In Arabic this is called the **mašdar** (مصدر, “source”). In Hebrew it corresponds to the **infinitive construct**. In Syriac it functions similarly and is often called the **infinitive** in grammars. It can serve as the subject of a sentence, the object of a verb, or — most commonly in narrative — as a **complementary infinitive** after a modal or semi-modal verb, introduced by the preposition ܠ- (“to”).

3.2 Infinitive Formation by Stem

Peal Infinitive: meCCaC pattern. Insert me- prefix and reduce the stem. E.g., k-t-b → **mektab** ܡܚܬܒ ‘the writing / to write’. Root š-m-‘ → **mešma** ܡܫܡܐ ‘the hearing’.

Paael Infinitive: mCaCCāCū — m- prefix, doubled middle radical, ā before the last radical, final ū. E.g., barrek (bless, Paael) → **mbarrākū** ܡܒܪܪܐܟܘܢ ‘the blessing’.

Aphel Infinitive: maCCāCū — ma- prefix with ā-vowel before final radical + ū. E.g., ‘appeq (bring out, Aphel) → **mappāqū** ܡܦܦܩܘܢ ‘to bring out’.

3.3 Infinitive Forms — Five Key Verbs

ROOT	MEANING	PEAL INF.	PAAEL INF.	APHEL INF.
k-t-b	write mektab כתב	mkatābū כתבו	'aktābū אכתב	
š-m-ʿ	hear mešma שמע	mšamā' ū שמוע	'ašmā' ū אשמע	
q-ṭ-l	kill meqṭal חמץ	mqaṭālū חמצו	'aqṭālū אחמץ	
p-q-d	command mepqad מצוה	mpaqādū מצוהו	'apqādū אמצוה	
y-d-ʿ	know mīda ידע	myādā' ū ידעו	'awdā' ū אידעו	

3.4 The Critical Construction: l- + Infinitive

The l- + Infinitive Construction

PATTERN: MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE

This construction expresses purpose or complement: 'he began to write', 'she is able to hear'.

The preposition l- is prefixed directly to the infinitive with no space.

Compare: Greek + infinitive (γράφειν); Latin accusative + infinitive (scribere); Arabic أن + imperfect.

In Hebrew the parallel is the lamed + infinitive construct: לִקְרוֹב (liktōv).

Eight Example Sentences with l- + Infinitive:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܫܪܝܠܡܟܬܒ * ܒ	šarī l-mektab* b	egan to.write H	e began to write.
ܝܐܟܠܡܝܫܡܐ * ܝ	yākel l-mešma ' * i	s.able to.hear H	e is able to hear.
ܒܐܝܠܡܡܐ * ܠܝܬܐܝܠܝܢ	bā ' ē l-me ' zal* w	ants to.go H	e wants to go.
ܫܒܐܠܡܢܩܬܐ * ܠܡܡܝܠܐ	šābē l-meqṭal* w	ishes to.kill H	e wishes to kill.
ܦܩܕܠܡܥܪܥ * ܠܡܡܝܠܐ	paqed l-me ' sar* c to.bind	ommanded H to bind.	e commanded (them)
ܫܕܪܠܡܥܒܕ * ܠܡܡܝܠܐ	šadar l-me ' bad* s	ent to.do/make H act.	e sent (them) to
ܠܐܝܐܟܠܠܡܥܠܐ * ܠܡܡܝܠܐ	lā yākel l-me ' zal* n to.go	ot is.able H go.	e is not able to
ܫܪܝܬܠܡܢܩܪܐ * ܡܠܬܐܝܬܐܠܡܢܩܪܐ	šarīt l-meqrā maltā* y to.read	ou.began Y the word. word.the	ou began to read

SECTION 4: VERBS OF BEGINNING, ABILITY, AND DESIRE

4.1 Semi-Modal Verbs

These verbs function like **modal auxiliaries** in English and govern an infinitive complement introduced by **l-**. They are extremely common in Syriac narrative. Master these verbs and their paradigms, as they appear repeatedly in the Acts of Mar Yukhannan.

š-r-y, 𐰽𐰺 — begin

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šarī, שָׁרִי

Example: שָׂרִי לִמְכַתֵּב, *šarī l-mektab* — He began to write.

Note: Very common in narrative openings. Note final yod (weak root š-r-y).

y-k-l **حَدَّ** — be able / can

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: yākel **حَدَّ**

Example: يَاكُلُ الْمِيتَةَ *yākel l-meqtal* — He is able to kill.

Note: The Syriac equivalent of Greek δύναμι, Latin possum. Often negated: lā yākel.

b-ʿ -y ܒܥ — want / seek / ask

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: bā ʿ ē ܒܥ

Example: ܒܥ ܠܡܥܠ ܒܐ ܥ ܠܡܥ ܐܝܠ — He wants to go.

Note: Can also mean ‘ask’ or ‘pray’. Third-aleph weak root.

ṣ-b-y ܒܥܝ — wish / will / be pleased

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: ṣābē ܒܥܝ

Example: ܒܥܝ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܣܒܐ ܠܡܥܬܐ — He wishes to kill.

Note: Related noun ṣebyānā (will/wish) is key theological vocabulary.

p-q-d ܦܩܕ — command / order

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: paqed ܦܩܕ

Example: ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܦܩܕ ܠܡܥ ܐܝܠ — He commanded to bind (him).

Note: Often takes a direct object (the recipient of the order) + l- + infinitive.

š-d-r ܫܕܪ — send

Stem: Peal Perfect 3msg: šadar ܫܕܪ

Example: ܫܕܪ ܠܡܥܬܐ ܫܕܪ ܠܡܥ ܐܝܠ — He sent men to kill.

Note: The l-+infinitive here expresses purpose: ‘sent in order to kill’.

SECTION 5: MILITARY AND EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS

This vocabulary set is essential for the narrative of Lesson 9. Many of these words appear in the story and

exercises. Learn both the verbal root and its noun/adjective derivatives.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>m-ḥ-y</i>	ܡܚܝ <i>mḥā / nemḥē</i>	strike, smite	, hit
<i>d-ḥ-l</i>	ܕܚܠ <i>*dḥel / nedḥa</i>	l* fear, be afra	id
<i>ḥ-d-y</i>	ܚܕܝ <i>ḥdī / neḥdē</i>	rejoice, be g	lad
<i>’-s-r</i>	ܫܪܐ <i>*’asar / ne’ s</i>	or* bind, tie, im	prison
<i>š-r-y</i>	ܫܪܝ <i>šrā / nešrē</i>	loosen, relea	se, begin
<i>r-m-y</i>	ܪܡܝ <i>rmā / nerme</i>	throw, cast	
<i>’-ḥ-d</i>	ܚܕܐ <i>*’ḥad / ne’ ḥo</i>	d* seize, grab,	take hold
<i>g-r-r</i>	ܓܪܪ <i>*grār / negro</i>	r* drag, pull	
<i>’-r-q</i>	ܪܩܐ <i>*’raq / ne’ ro</i>	q* flee, escape	
<i>r-d-p</i>	ܪܕܦ <i>*rdap / nerdo</i>	p* pursue, chase	, persecute
<i>q-ṭ-l</i>	ܩܬܠ <i>*qṭal / neqṭo</i>	l* kill, slay	
<i>p-ṣ-’</i>	ܨܣܐ <i>*pṣā’ / nepsa</i>	’ * wound, injure	
<i>z-’-q</i>	ܨܩܐ <i>*z’aq / nez’ o</i>	q* cry out, shou	t
<i>p-q-d</i>	ܩܕܦ <i>*pqad / nepqo</i>	d* command, orde	r
<i>k-n-š</i>	ܩܢܫ <i>*knaš / neksn</i>	oš* gather, assem	ble
<i>estrātyōṭā</i>	ܐܫܬܪܬܝܘܬܐ <i>estrātyōṭā</i>	soldier (Gree	k loanword: στρατιώτης)
<i>ḥaylā</i>	ܚܐܝܠܐ <i>ḥaylā</i>	army; strengt	h, power (dual meaning)
<i>saypā</i>	ܫܝܦܐ <i>saypā</i>	sword	
<i>nūrā</i>	ܢܘܪܐ <i>nūrā</i>	fire	
<i>’attūnā</i>	ܐܬܬܘܢܐ <i>’attūnā</i>	furnace, oven	
<i>šalšaltā</i>	ܫܠܫܠܬܐ <i>šalšaltā</i>	chain (relate	d to Heb. שְׁלֹשָׁלַת)
<i>gūbbā</i>	ܓܘܒܒܐ <i>gūbbā</i>	pit, cistern;	den (as in lion’s den)
<i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	ܒܝܬܐ ܫܝܪܐ <i>bēt-’sīrē</i>	prison (lit.	‘house of the bound ones’)
<i>kansā</i>	ܩܢܫܐ <i>kansā</i>	crowd, gather	ing, assembly

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>qālā</i>	קָלַל <i>qālā</i>	voice, sound	
<i>rugzā</i>	רָגַז <i>rugzā</i>	anger, wrath	
<i>dehltā</i>	דָּחַל <i>dehltā</i>	fear (noun; f	rom d-h-l)
<i>'ammīnūttā</i>	אָמַן <i>'ammīnūttā</i>	steadfastness	, courage, endurance
<i>pūqdānā</i>	פָּקַד <i>pūqdānā</i>	command, comm	andment (noun from p-q-d)
<i>ṣebyānā</i>	שָׁבַח <i>ṣebyānā</i>	will, wish, d	esire (key theological term)

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 9

The King Commands: Seize Yukhannan

The narrative reaches a climax. Having heard reports of Yukhannan's preaching and miracles, the king summons his soldiers and issues a series of direct commands. The passage is rich in imperatives and *l-* + infinitive constructions, giving you immediate practice in the new grammar.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܢ ܕܐ ܫܡܐ ܕܬ ܡܠܠܐ ܗܠܐܢ	malkā den kad šma ‘ t he.heard wor	he.king now when N ds these heard these	ow when the king words,
ܐܬܡܠܝ ܒܪܘܓܝܐ ܗܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܩܠܐ ܩܠܐ ܩܠܐ	’etmalī b-rugzā h ā rabbā* with-anger	e.was.filled h anger and cr and-he.cried.out with- voice great	e was filled with ied out with a great voice.
ܠܥܫܬܪܬܝܘܬܐ ܡܠܟܐ	paqed h w(hy)* to- his.soldi	e.commanded H ers soldiers,	e commanded his
ܠܝܗܢܢ ܐܠܝܐ ܕܥܙܠܐ ܠܥܬܝܠ	’ezlaw w- ’eḥodw g Yukhannan (ob	o.pl! and seize.pl! ” j.) Yukhannan!	Go and seize
ܡܠܟܐ ܕܢ ܕܐ ܫܡܐ ܕܬ ܡܠܠܐ ܗܠܐܢ	w- ’atīw w- ’armōhy a and-throw.hi	nd-come.pl! C m! into the fur in-the.furnace	ome and throw him nace!
ܠܐܬܬܐܘܠܡܢ ܡܠܟܐ ܕܢ ܕܐ ܫܡܐ ܕܬ ܡܠܠܐ ܗܠܐܢ	lā tedḥlūn men n signs- his	ot you.fear.pl from D signs!”	o not fear his
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	estrāṭyōṭē šarīw s to.go l-me ’zal	oldiers they.began T to go.	he soldiers began
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	bā ‘ ē ḥad mennhon w to.turn.back	anted one from-them O to turn back	ne of them wanted .
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	’emar: lā yākelnan h dīqā* we.are.able	e.said not H to.kill not able to righteous.man	e said: ‘We are kill a righteous man.’
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	’aḥrānē ’asrw o šalšaltā* hands-his wi	thers they.bound O th- chain hands with a	thers bound his chain.
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	w-grarwōhy lawāt a toward furna	nd-they.dragged.him A ce him toward t	nd they dragged he furnace.
ܠܡܠܠܐ ܕܥܬܝܠ ܡܠܟܐ	Yūḥannan dēn lā Yu allī* dhāl ’ellā ṣ	khannan but not Bu t not fear; in he.prayed	t Yukhannan did stead he prayed.

Smooth English Translation:

Now when the king heard these words, he was filled with anger and cried out with a great voice. He commanded his soldiers: “Go and seize Yukhannan! Come and throw him into the furnace! Do not fear his signs!” The soldiers began

to go. One of them wanted to turn back. He said: “We are not able to kill a righteous man.” Others bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace. But Yukhannan did not fear; instead he prayed.

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

Write out all four imperative forms (msg, fsg, mpl, fpl) for each of the following roots in the Peal stem. Include Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. ' -z-l (go) — Peal imperfect 2msg: tēzal → imperative: ?
2. ' -b-d (do, make) — Peal imperfect 2msg: te ' bod → imperative: ?
3. q-r- ' (read, call) — Peal imperfect 2msg: teqrā → imperative: ?

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation

Form the Peal, Paael, and Aphel infinitives for each root. Use the pattern: Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCaCCāCū; Aphel = maCCāCū.

1. n-p-q (go out)
2. q-b-l (receive)
3. š-d-r (send)
4. ḥ-z-y (see)
5. ' -l-l (enter)
6. y-l-d (give birth)
7. r-ḥ-m (have mercy)
8. s-g-d (worship)

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into English. Identify any imperatives and l-+infinitive constructions.

1. ܡܠܟܐ ܕܝܫܪܐ ܕܝܫܪܐ

2. ܐܡܪ, ܡܠܟܐ ܕܐܠܡܐ.
3. ܠܐ ܗܝܠܝܬ.
4. ܐܝܬ, ܠܡܢܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
5. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
6. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
7. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.
8. ܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ ܠܡܠܟܐ ܡܠܟܐ.

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Express each sentence in Syriac. Use Estrangela script and transliteration.

1. Hear me, O king! (m.sg.)
2. Do not kill the righteous man! (m.pl.)
3. He began to pray.
4. The soldier is not able to flee.
5. The king commanded to throw him into the furnace.
6. She wants to read the book.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6 and answer the following questions in English.

1. Why did the king fill with anger?
2. What two commands did the king give his soldiers?
3. What did one soldier say? Why was he reluctant?
4. How was Yukhannan restrained before being brought to the furnace?
5. How did Yukhannan respond to his situation?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Imperative Paradigm

'-z-l (go):

- msg: 'ezal עזאל
- fsg: 'ezlī עזלי
- mpl: 'ezlaw עזלאל
- fpl: 'ezlān עזלאל

'-b-d (do):

- msg: 'bod בוד
- fsg: 'bodī בודי
- mpl: 'bodw בודאל
- fpl: 'bodān בודאל

q-r-' (read/call):

- msg: qrī קרי (III-aleph/yod: vowel changes)
- fsg: qrīy קריי
- mpl: qrīw קריאל
- fpl: qrīn קריאל

Exercise 2: Infinitive Formation (selected answers)

n-p-q: Peal mappaq מפקע; Paael mnappāqū מנפקעאל; Aphel mappāqū מפקעאל

š-d-r: Peal mešdar משרד; Paael mšadrū משרדאל; Aphel 'ašdrū משרדאל

y-l-d: Peal mīlad מליד; Paael myāladū מלידאל; Aphel 'auldū מלידאל

Exercise 3: Translation

1. Go to Jerusalem!
2. Hear the voice of God! (to a woman)
3. Do not cry out! (m.pl.)
4. He began to read the book.
5. The king wanted to bind Yukhannan.
6. God is able to strike the soldiers.
7. He commanded them to throw (him) into the furnace.
8. Yukhannan wished to pray.

Exercise 4: Production

1. שמעו, מלכא šma ' nī malkā
2. לא תעטלו לזדק לא לā teqtlūn l-zaddīqā
3. שרי, לשרי šarī l-mešlā
4. עזרו, עזרו estrāṭyōṭā lā yākel l-me ' raq
5. פקד מלכא לזדק לא ל-paqed malkā l-mermyū leh b- ' attūnā
6. בא, בא bā ' yā l-meqrā ketābā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. He heard the words (reports) about Yukhannan and was filled with anger.
2. (1) Seize Yukhannan; (2) throw him into the furnace.
3. One soldier said they were not able to kill a righteous man — showing moral hesitation.
4. They bound his hands with a chain and dragged him toward the furnace.
5. Yukhannan did not fear; he prayed instead.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

The Imperative at a Glance

FORM	ENDING	EXAMPLE (K-T-B)	ESTRANGELA
Masculine Singular	CCoC (bare k stem)	tob ܬܒ	ܬܒܐܬܐ
Feminine Singular	CCoC + k ī	tobī ܬܒܝ	ܬܒܝܐܬܐ
Masculine Plural	CCoC + k w	tobw ܬܒܘ	ܬܒܘܐܬܐ
Feminine Plural	CCoC + k ān	tobān ܬܒܢܐ	ܬܒܢܐܬܐ

Infinitive Patterns

STEM	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Peal	meCCaC mektab ܡܝܬܒܐ	Most common;	parallel to Hebrew inf. construct with l-
Paael	mCaCCāCū mbarrākū ܡܒܪܪܐܕܐܝܬܐ	Double middl	e radical characteristic
Aphel	maCCāCū mappāqū ܡܦܩܐܝܬܐ	'a- prefix as	in the Aphel perfect

The l- + Infinitive Construction

Quick Reference

MAIN VERB + l- + INFINITIVE = 'to [do X]'

šarī l-mektab = He began to write

yākel l-mešma' = He is able to hear

bā' ē l-me' zal = He wants to go

paqed l-me' sar = He commanded to bind

NEGATIVE: lā + IMPERFECT (not imperative!) for prohibitions